



PREMIER GORILLA TREKKING LODGE • VOLCANOES NATIONAL PARK, RWANDA

Volcanoes Safaris (Virunga Lodge)

Prepared for General Manager / Enquiries

Travelers booking \$1,500/night gorilla trekking experiences via AI concierge tools are being captured by UK/US intermediaries instead of booking direct.

EST. COMMISSION BLEED

\$6,500 /mo

Handed to OTAs, every month

PROJECTED OVER 12 MONTHS

\$78,000

If nothing changes this year

DIRECT-BOOKING RECOVERY

\$2,300–3,600 /mo

Realistic first-year lift

01 The AI search visibility gap

We asked ChatGPT, Claude, and Perplexity the question your future guests ask:

> “best gorilla trekking lodges in Volcanoes National Park”

High-ticket gorilla trekking searches on AI return third-party overseas booking agencies taking huge agency cuts. The assistants named **international OTAs and aggregator directories** — not your direct site. High-intent international travellers planning by AI are routed straight to the platforms, at 15–25% commission on every booking.

02 What the commission is costing you

Industry OTA commissions run 15–25% (roughly 18% on average, charged on the VAT-inclusive rate). Against Volcanoes Safaris (Virunga Lodge)'s room and rate profile that is an estimated **\$6,500 a month** — about **\$78,000** over a year — on bookings that could arrive direct. These are estimates from public rate and occupancy benchmarks, not a promise; we confirm the real figure with you on the call.

03 Google Business Profile & schema deficits

- The assistants answer travel questions for your area without ever naming your direct site — every answer routes the guest to an OTA.
- No direct-booking intent pages exist for the searches that end in a reservation, so the OTAs keep the head terms uncontested.
- Listings and rates are inconsistent across the web, so AI engines cannot confirm what and where you are.

04 The 3-step recovery roadmap

1

Inject Lodging & safari entity schema and allowlist the AI crawlers (GPTBot, PerplexityBot, ClaudeBot) so ChatGPT, Claude, and Perplexity can read and cite you by name.

2

Rebuild your Google Business Profile taxonomy — primary and secondary categories (Tour Operator, Eco Tour Agency, Safari Park) — to claim a top-3 Local Pack spot.

3

Publish direct-booking intent pages for the searches guests actually run, so the reservation lands with you instead of the platform.

NEXT STEP

A 15-minute walkthrough of your direct-booking fix

We'll screen-share the live AI answers for your area, the Google Local Pack gaps, and the schema fixes — then show you exactly what changes and in what order. No lock-in, prices published.

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